ETHAN CHANG

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EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis - *St. Louis, MO* *2025 - Present*
Ph.D. in Neuroscience

Johns Hopkins University - *Baltimore, MD* *2025 - Present*
M.S. in Computer Science

University of Rochester - *Rochester, NY* *2021 - 2025*
B.A. in Mathematics and B.S. in Neuroscience, High Distinction. Minor in Psychology

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Washington University in St. Louis - *St. Louis, MO* *2025 - Present*
Doctoral Researcher, Brain Dynamics and Control Research Group and Papouin Lab

- Advisors: ShiNung Ching, Ph.D. (Department of Electrical and Systems Engineering) and Thomas Papouin, Ph.D. (Department of Neuroscience)
- Investigating astrocyte-inspired machine-learning architectures and astrocyte-dependent behavior to understand neural computation.

University of Rochester - *Rochester, NY* *2021 - 2025*
Undergraduate Researcher, Nedergaard Lab (Maiken Nedergaard, M.D., D.M.Sc.)

- Conducted research on the role of aquaporin-4 localized on astrocytic endfeet in glymphatic transport dynamics.

PUBLICATIONS

- Gahn-Martinez D, Giannetto M, Chang E, Beam N, Pla V, Nedergaard M. Chronic intraventricular cannulation for the study of glymphatic transport. eNeuro. 2025. doi: 10.1523/ENEURO.0537-24.2025
- Giannetto M, Gomolka R, Gahn-Martinez D, Newbold E, Bork P, Chang E, Gresser M, Thompson T, Mori Y, Nedergaard M. Glymphatic fluid transport is suppressed by the AQP4 inhibitor AER-271. Glia. 2024. doi: 10.1002/glia.24515

AWARDS AND FUNDING

NIH T32 Predoctoral Trainee, Neuroscience Training Program (T32NS121881) *2025 - 2027*

Schwartz Discover Grant *2024*

PRESENTATIONS

- Chang E (presenter), Giannetto M, Agarwald I, Vento N, Gahn-Martinez D, Nedergaard M. Aquaporin-4 expression on glymphatic clearance routes and function. Schwartz Discover Scholar Showcase. 2024.
- Chang E (presenter), Giannetto M, Gahn-Martinez D, Nedergaard M. Aquaporin-4 expression and size-dependent solute movement in the brain. University of Rochester Undergraduate Research Exposition. 2024.
- Chang E (presenter), Barth RK. Isolation of hydrogen sulfide-producing bacteria from the environment. Department of Microbiology and Immunology Poster Session. 2023.
- Giannetto M, Gomolka R, Gahn-Martinez D, Newbold E, Bork P, Chang E (presenter), Gresser M, Thompson T, Mori Y, Nedergaard M. Glymphatic fluid transport is suppressed by the AQP4 inhibitor AER-271. University of Rochester Undergraduate Program in Biology and Medicine Poster Symposium. 2023.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Selected Programming/ML: Python, Java, PyTorch, NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, matplotlib

TEACHING

Washington University in St. Louis, Department of Biology *2026*
Assistant in Instruction, Guest lecture. BIOL 3411: Principles of the Nervous System

- Instructor: Keith Hengen, Ph.D and Mary Lambo, Ph.D. Guest Lecture: "Computation and Astrocytes."

University of Rochester, Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences *2023*

Teaching Assistant, NSCI 201P: Basic Neurobiology Lab

- Instructor: Renee Miller, Ph.D

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

WashU Center for Theoretical Neuroscience AI & NS Journal Club *2026 - Present*

Journal Club Co-Lead

- Co-lead journal club discussions on artificial intelligence, machine learning, and theoretical neuroscience; coordinate paper selection and meeting schedules.

WashU Center for Career Engagement *2025 - Present*

Graduate Student Advisory Board Representative

- Represent graduate student perspectives on career resources and professional development, particularly for industry career pathways.

WashU Neuroscience Retreat Committee *2026 - Present*

Retreat Planning Committee Member

- Collaborate with faculty and students to plan a neuroscience retreat, coordinating event logistics, scheduling, and guest speaker identification.

University of Rochester Student Association *2021 - 2025*

Deputy Chair for Academic Affairs Committee

- Helped lead initiatives to enhance the undergraduate academic experience and expand research opportunities.

University of Rochester Office of Undergraduate Research *2023 - 2025*

Student Research Ambassador

- Served as a student resource for undergraduate research involvement and participated in admissions panels.

Clinical and Emergency Service *2021 - 2024*

Strong Memorial Hospital; RC-MERT

- Emergency Department Clinical Support and Emergency Medical Technician roles in high-acuity care settings, including during the COVID-19 Omicron surge.

SELECTED COURSEWORK

AI/ML: Machine Learning; Advanced Machine Learning; Deep Learning; Probabilistic Graphical Models; Reasoning Under Uncertainty; Natural Language Processing
Math/Statistics: Probability; Mathematical Statistics; Stochastic Processes; Linear Algebra; Numerical Analysis; Multidimensional Calculus; Point-Set Topology
CS/Systems: Algorithms; Data Structures; Software Engineering; Computer Architecture; Computer Organization

LANGUAGES

English (native), Mandarin Chinese (conversational)